LESSON 1

Hot Cross Buns

A street cry: bakers sang it in London on Good Friday to sell their spiced buns. It was written down in 1733.

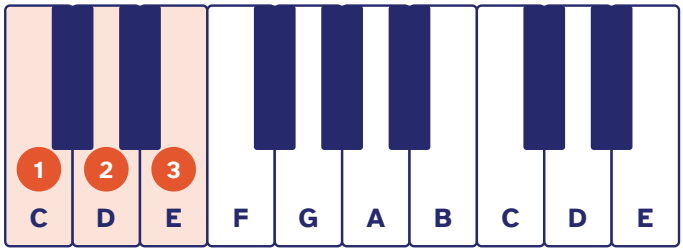
IN THIS SONG **three notes: E D C** **steps down** **walk and run-ning** **fingers 3 2 1**

LISTEN FIRST

Hear the whole song before you take it apart: scan the code, listen once, then hum along the second time.

1 Listen and sing

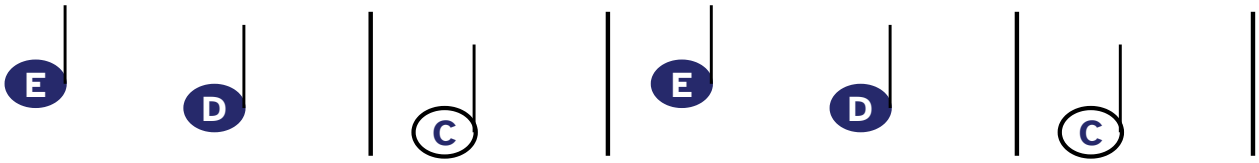
Listen, pointing to each note as it sounds. Then sing it with the words, then again on the letter names inside the notes.



middle C

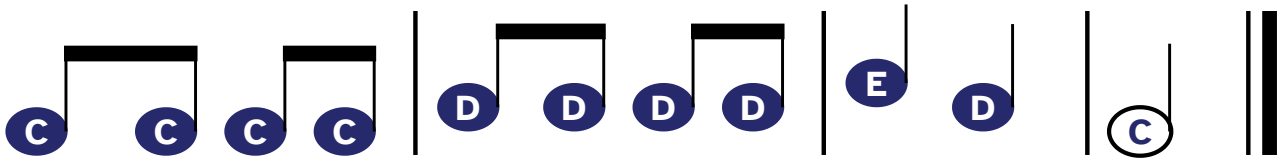
Your hand. Right thumb (1) on middle C, fingers 2 and 3 on D and E.

Steps down. Each note is the next key down: E, D, C. On the page each one sits a step lower, so the tune looks the way it sounds.



Hot cross buns, Hot cross buns,

5



One a pen-ny, two a pen-ny, Hot cross buns.

☐ Listened and pointed ☐ Sang it with the words ☐ Sang the letter names

2 Take it apart

The same song, one piece at a time: first its rhythm, then its notes.

THE RHYTHM

Say the words in time, then clap them and count: clap on the coral numbers, hold through the grey ones.

THE BEAT

Count 1 2 in every bar, steady as a clock: two beats a bar.
Walk on a beat; run two quick notes in one beat: say *pen-ny*, count *1 +*.

THE NOTES



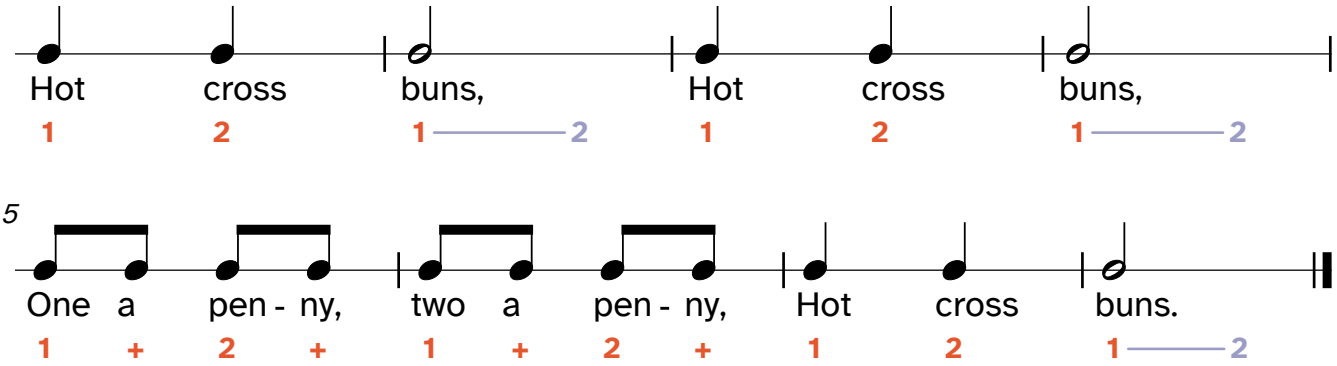
crotchet: walk
1 beat



two quavers: run-ning
1 beat

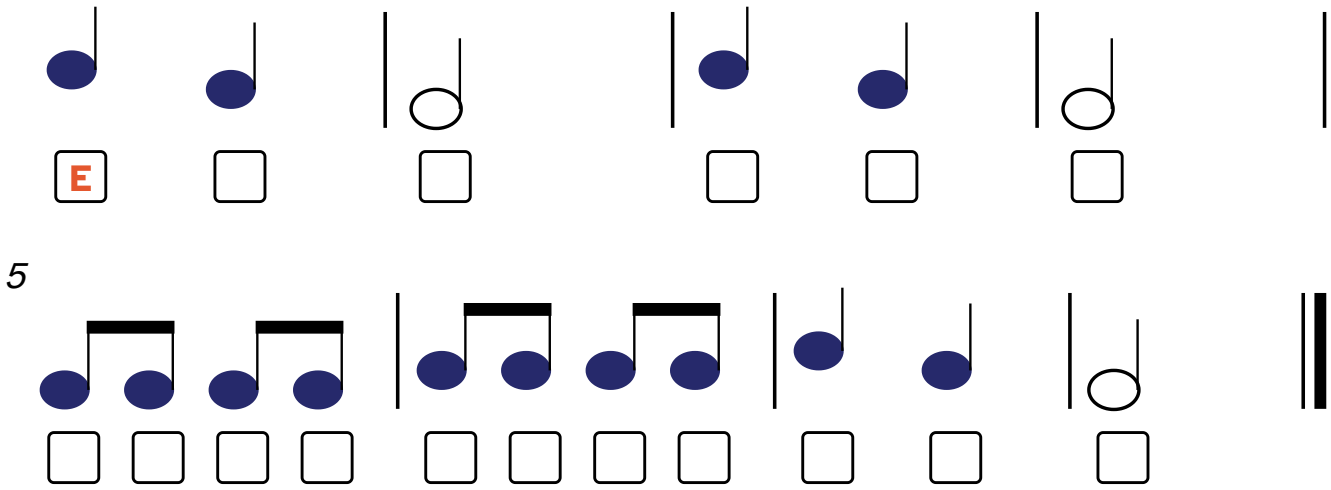


minim
2 beats



THE NOTES

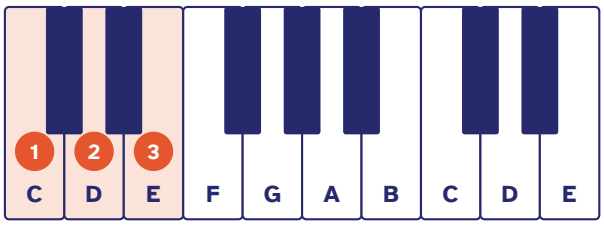
Now the notes are empty. Write E, D or C in each box, then sing it on the letter names.



- [ ] **Said it in time**
- [ ] **Clapped and counted**
- [ ] **Ran on “one a penny”**
- [ ] **Wrote the letter names**

3 Play it

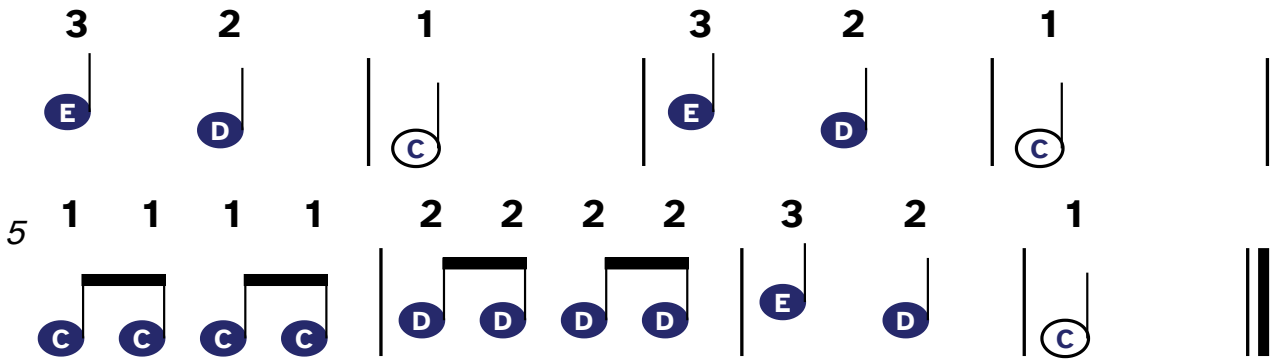
The white keys C D E, with the right hand, then the left.



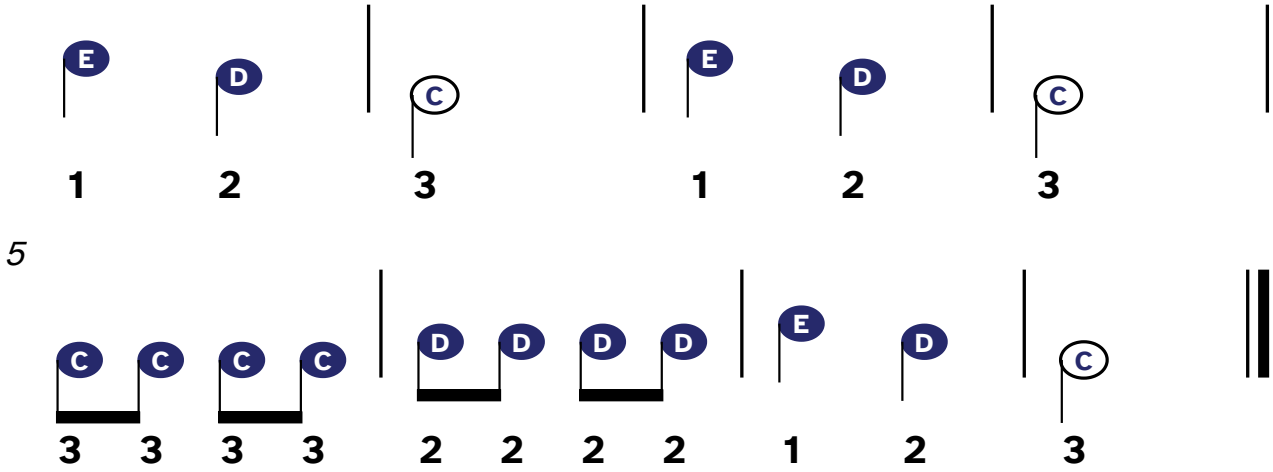
middle C

Right hand: thumb on middle C, then 2 on D and 3 on E. **Left hand:** an octave lower, 3 on C, 2 on D, thumb on E.

R RIGHT HAND 3 2 1



L LEFT HAND 1 2 3, an octave lower



4 · CHECK

- ☐ I can say and clap it
- ☐ I can sing it with the words
- ☐ I can sing the letter names

I can play it:

☐ Right hand ☐ Left hand

TEACHER ☐ Pass ☐ Not yet